

Agency — Research Call Flow

Market research, not a sales call — 3-5 min, no pitch. Target: Operations Manager / Director of Operations, or whoever owns the workflow (often the owner at smaller firms).

1. Opening — disarm, frame as research (10-15 sec)

"Hi, is this [Name]? I'm doing some research into how property management companies handle [task]. Not selling anything today — just trying to understand how teams like yours handle this. Got 3-4 minutes?"

If no: "No problem — better time, or someone else who'd know this side best?" Don't push past a real no.

2. Warm-up / role confirmation

"What's your role there, and roughly how many properties does your team manage?"

3. Manual or automated? (qualification criterion 1)

"Walk me through how [the task] gets handled day to day right now — is that a person on your team doing it manually, or does software handle most of it already?"

4. Real labor cost? (qualification criterion 2)

"About how many people, or how much time, is tied up in that process week to week?"

"If that got automated or cut down to a fraction of the time, would that actually move the needle — or not a big enough cost to matter?"

5. Current PMS platform

"What system are you using to manage the properties day to day — AppFolio, Buildium, Guesty, something else?"

Every answer here helps scope the first integration, even beyond this prospect.

6. Pain point (verbatim, for the weekly review)

"What's the most frustrating part of that whole process for your team right now?"

Let them talk. Don't interrupt to solve it — capture their exact words.

7. Close — soft, no pitch

"This is really helpful. I'm working on something that might address exactly this — still early, but would it be alright if I followed up once I have something concrete to show you?"

Call log — fill in right after each call, while it's fresh

Firm / Contact	Role	Manual?	Real labor cost?	Qualified?	PMS	Pain point (one line)

Qualified = Manual? Yes AND Real labor cost? Yes. Applicability rate = qualified ÷ total conversations — the metric that matters, not conversation count. Full flow + criteria: domains/agency-research-call-flow.md, domains/agency.md.